

Tianyi Zhang

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-Computer Interaction, Human-AI Interaction, Computer Supported Cooperative Work

EDUCATION

Singapore Management University <i>PhD in Computer Science</i>	2023 - Now Singapore
Nanjing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics <i>MSc in Computer Science</i>	2018 - 2021 Nanjing, China
Nanjing University of Aeronautics and Astronautics <i>BSc in Information Security</i>	2014 - 2018 Nanjing, China

HONORS AND AWARDS

Honorable Mention Award, DIS 2026 (top 5% of submissions, co-first author) <i>Group Conversational Agents: A Review of Designs that Support and Shape Group Interaction</i>	2026
SMU Presidential Doctoral Fellowship <i>Award for recognising existing PhD students who have demonstrated sustained excellence in research</i>	2025-2026
Honorable Mention Award, IEEE VIS 2025 (top 5% of submissions) <i>Qualitative Study for LLM-assisted Design Study Process: Strategies, Challenges, and Roles</i>	2025
Honorable Mention Award, CHI 2025 (top 5% of submissions, first author) <i>Prompting an Embodied AI Agent: How Embodiment and Multimodal Signaling Affects Prompting Behaviour</i>	2025
Honorable Mention, IEEE VAST Challenge 2022. <i>ClusBridges: Clustering Life Routines and Data</i>	2022
Award for Effectively Transforming Task Decomposition into Conceptual Design, IEEE VAST Challenge 2020. <i>Visualization on High Level Situation Awareness and Team Assembly for Cyber Security Events</i>	2020

FULL PAPERS

- [1] **Tianyi Zhang**, Emran Poh, Yueyue Hou, Yi-Chieh LEE, Renwen Zhang, Jiannan Li, Anthony Tang. **“Grandpa, Can You Speak Nicer?”: Envisioned Chatbot Roles and Design Tensions in Intergenerational Communication Conflicts.** In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '26)*. Acceptance rate 21%.
- [2] Shun Yi Yeo*, **Tianyi Zhang***, Scott Bateman, Gary Hsieh, Young-Ho Kim, Simon Tangi Perrault, Jiannan Li, Anthony Tang. **Group Conversational Agents: A Review of Designs that Support and Shape Group Interaction.** In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '26)*. **Honorable Mention Award (top 5%).** Acceptance rate 21%.
* Equal contribution (co-first authors).
- [3] Pei-Hua Tsai, **Tianyi Zhang**, Emran Poh, Anthony Tang, Yung-Ju Chang. **Not Too Early, Not All at Once: Design Tensions in AI-Mediated Self-Disclosure in Online Dating.** In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '26)*. Acceptance rate 21%.
- [4] Emran Poh, Yueyue Hou, **Tianyi Zhang**, Jiannan Li, **‘Show It, Don’t Just Say It’: The Complementary Effects of Instruction Multimodality for Software Guidance.** In *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26)*. Acceptance rate 25.3% (1703/6730).
- [5] Shaolun Ruan, Rui Sheng, Xiaolin Wen, Jiachen Wang, **Tianyi Zhang**, Yong Wang, Tim Dwyer, Jiannan Li, **Qualitative Study for LLM-assisted Design Study Process: Strategies, Challenges, and Roles.** In *IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (TVCG 2025)*. **Honorable Mention Award (top 5%).** Acceptance rate 24.4% (131/537).
- [6] **Tianyi Zhang**, Colin Au Yeung, Emily Aurelia, Yuki Onishi, Neil Chulpongsatorn, Jiannan Li, Anthony Tang. **Prompting an Embodied AI Agent: How Embodiment and Multimodal Signaling Affects Prompting Behaviour.** In *Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. **Honorable Mention Award (top 5%).** Acceptance rate 24.9% (1249/5014).
- [7] Setareh Aghel Manesh, **Tianyi Zhang**, Yuki Onishi, Kotaro Hara, Scott Bateman, Jiannan Li, Anthony Tang. **How People Prompt Generative AI to Create Interactive VR Scenes.** In *Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS '24)*. Acceptance rate 27.4% (190/695).
- [8] **Tianyi Zhang**, Jian Wang. **Secure Outsourcing Algorithms of Modular Exponentiations in Edge Computing.** In *IEEE 19th International Conference on Trust, Security and Privacy in Computing and Communications (TrustCom '20)*.

INDUSTRY EMPLOYMENT

Software Engineer

UNISOC Spreadtrum Communications, Inc.

2021 - 2023

Nanjing, China

SERVICE

Associate Chair

CHI 2026 (Posters)

Student Volunteer Co-Chair

ICHEC 2025

Workshop Organizer

ICHEC 2025 Workshop: Conversational Agents for Good

Reviewer

IEEE VR 2026, ICHEC 2025

Student Volunteer

CHI 2025

Teaching Assistant

IS1704, CS711

REFEREE

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